

All targets, evidence and record

FMAM 2026 — February initialization · FMAM rainfall domain (FMAM >= 20% of annual and >= 100 mm)

Target	Below/near/above	Coverage	Anomaly	Verification status
FMAM 2026	24% / 33% / 43%	100%	+29 mm	Verification published
Feb 2026	28% / 45% / 27%	81%	−2 mm	Verification published
Mar 2026	31% / 34% / 35%	91%	+4 mm	Verification published
Apr 2026	27% / 30% / 43%	100%	+26 mm	Verification published
May 2026	35% / 33% / 32%	100%	−2 mm	Verification published

Historical skill, cross-validated (probability skill, RPSS, with whole-year 95% interval)

Target	RPSS (95% interval)	Yrs better	Holm p	In words
FMAM	+0.020 (−0.042 to +0.077)	15/24	1.000	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
Feb	+0.145 (+0.050 to +0.247)	17/24	0.018	Moderate improvement over climatology (interval above zero)
Mar	+0.011 (−0.032 to +0.054)	17/24	1.000	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
Apr	+0.012 (−0.033 to +0.051)	14/24	1.000	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
May	+0.011 (−0.056 to +0.061)	17/24	1.000	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain

Verification against CHIRPS (single season or month)

Target	RPSS	CRPSS	Bias	Forecast / observed anomaly	Observed below/near/above
FMAM 2026	+0.130	+0.062	−27.0 mm	+29 / +56 mm	3% / 45% / 52%
Feb 2026	+0.142	+0.048	−2.1 mm	−2 / 0 mm	32% / 44% / 24%
Mar 2026	+0.066	+0.057	−72.1 mm	+4 / +77 mm	0% / 2% / 98%
Apr 2026	−0.159	−0.633	+41.9 mm	+26 / −16 mm	44% / 37% / 19%
May 2026	+0.002	−0.056	+3.6 mm	−2 / −5 mm	38% / 44% / 18%

Cycle record

Model initialization: 1 February 2026 · ECMWF SEAS5 (system 51), 51 members

Target period: 1 Feb 2026 – 31 May 2026

Forecast record: Frozen 9 Oct 2026 (after the target period ended, before this project downloaded its observations; SHA-256 manifest)

Publication status: Research reconstruction: produced after the initialization date with the published method; not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

Reference period: CHIRPS v2.0 FMAM 1993–2025 (33 seasons)

Observations processed through: May 2026 (Feb, Mar, Apr, May)

CHIRPS archive: Official CHIRPS v2.0 p25 by_month listing checked 10 Oct 2026: monthly files through Aug 2026; Feb 2026 file not found

Verification last run: 10 Oct 2026

Method / version: Shared climatology blend ($\lambda = 0.44$ for FMAM) · code ca3165c

How to read: terciles split the reference-period rainfall into three equally likely parts. Climatology assigns about one-third to each (the observed tercile frequencies of the training years). Skill scores are decimals: +0.05 means a 5% lower score than climatology. RPSS refers to the blended probabilities; CRPSS and bias to the amount-corrected ensemble.

Limitations: few evaluation years and single verification seasons give wide uncertainty; the 0.25° maps repeat ~1° model information; the rainfall domain is for display and summaries only.

Monthly tercile outlooks

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